

ALTOSTRAT SINGAPORE EMPLOYEE POLICY HANDBOOK & CONDUCT GUIDELINES

Confidential — Internal Use Only

Applicability: All Altostrat Singapore Employees, Interns, and Extended Workforce (Temps, Vendors, and Contractors)

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SECTION 1: PAID TIME OFF & LEAVE OPERATIONS

1.1 Outpatient Sick Time & Hospitalization Leave (Singapore)

Altostrat Singapore provides paid sick leave to support your health and recovery when you are medically certified as unfit for work.

- **Outpatient Sick Leave Allowance:** Eligible employees and interns receive up to **14 days of paid outpatient sick leave** per calendar year, compensated at 100% of their base salary. Part-time and fixed-term employees' leave is prorated based on their contracted working hours.
- **Hospitalization Leave Allowance:** Employees can utilize an additional **46 work days of paid hospitalization leave** per year. This is not an extension of outpatient sick leave but is granted for inpatient stays, day surgeries, quarantine orders, or serious medical conditions certified by a medical practitioner employed by an approved hospital.
- **Notification Requirements:** You must notify your manager that you need to take sick or hospitalization leave **at least one hour before your normal start time**. If your manager is unavailable, you must contact support.
- **Medical Certificate (MC) Submission:**
 - If you are sick for **more than two work days**, you must submit your sick certificate from a registered medical practitioner via WorkWeek.
 - This certificate must be submitted **within 48 hours** of taking the leave.
 - Altostrat reserves the right to decline paid sick leave or classify the absence as unpaid if the MC is not submitted. Unapproved absences can result in disciplinary action.

1.2 Paid Vacation Leave (Singapore)

Vacation time is provided to help employees detach from work and recharge.

Employees earned their full vacation entitlement for the year on January 1.

- **Accrual Tier Matrix:** The number of days accrued is based on years of continuous service:
 - **1 to 6 years of service:** 20 days per year.
 - **7 to 10 years of service:** 21 days per year.
 - **11+ years of service:** 22 days per year.

- **Proration:** Employees in their first year of service receive a prorated number of vacation days based on their start date. Part-time employees accrue prorated hours based on their individual FTE percentage (e.g., 50% FTE accrues 50% of the vacation rate).
- **Booking and Scheduling Rules:**
 - Vacation can be taken in half-day or full-day increments.
 - Shift workers must book vacation based on actual shift hours. For instance, a **12-hour shift requires 1.5 vacation days** (defined as 8-hour blocks).
 - You must discuss and obtain approval from your manager for your planned dates **at least 15 days in advance**.
 - Any changes or cancellations to booked vacation must be processed **at least 15 days before the leave starts**.
- **Carryover & Pay-out Limitations:** All unused vacation days from the current year carry over for **exactly one additional year**. Carried-over days must be used by December 31 of the following year or they are forfeited. Altostrat does not pay out unused vacation, except upon country-to-country transfer or termination of employment.
- **Floating Holidays:** If a recognized public holiday falls on a Saturday or Sunday, employees are granted a floating holiday, which must be utilized like vacation before the calendar year ends. Floating holidays do not carry forward and are not cashed out upon termination.
- **System Constraints & Validity:** All leave requests must be chronologically valid (the start date cannot occur after the end date). Furthermore, the system will automatically reject any leave request that exceeds the employee's current accrued balance.

1.3 Childcare Leave (Singapore)

Paid childcare leave is available for eligible parents with children under the age of 12.

- **Allowance Categories:**
 - **6 days of paid leave per year** if your children are under 7 years old.
 - **2 days of paid leave per year** if your youngest child is between 7 and 12 years old.
 - **6 days of paid leave per year** if you have children in both age groups.
- **Usage:** Leave is counted in full work days. Once agreed with your manager, you must record it in WorkWeek. Unused childcare leave does not carry over and is not paid out upon leaving the company.

1.4 Time Off in Lieu (TOIL) (Singapore)

- If you are required by the business to work on a public holiday or during the weekend, you can claim **time off in lieu** to compensate for working outside your contractual hours.
- TOIL is granted and taken at your manager's discretion.
- There is no need to enter TOIL in WorkWeek; you must talk with your manager to agree on the time off and **use your TOIL days before logging additional vacation days**.

SECTION 2: FAMILY-BUILDING & TRANSITION LEAVES

2.1 Maternity Leave (Singapore)

Paid maternity leave is offered to support pregnancy, recovery from childbirth, and infant bonding.

- **Duration:** Effective 1 April 2026, all eligible employees are entitled to **24 weeks of paid parental leave**.
- **Shared Parental Leave (SPL) Extension:** Under Phase 2 of Singapore's MSF scheme, parents of Singaporean children born on or after 1 April 2026 are entitled to 10 weeks of shared parental leave (default split is 5 weeks for each parent).
 - **SPL Donation:** If your spouse donates their portion (up to 10 weeks) of SPL to you, your total paid maternity leave can be extended to **25 or 26 weeks**.
 - **SPL Allocation Audit:** Regardless of the split, you must submit proof of the official SPL allocation from LifeSG within 4 weeks of birth/adoption for record-keeping and statutory audits.
 - **Moms Donating SPL:** If you donate your portion of SPL to your spouse, your Altostrat maternity leave is *not* reduced below the 24-week baseline, as company benefits are already inclusive of and exceed statutory limits.
- **Interns:** Eligible interns who have served for a continuous period of at least 3 months are entitled to **16 weeks of statutory maternity leave**, which must be taken consecutively. Interns whose spouses donate SPL can extend their leave up to 26 weeks.
- **Administrative Procedures:**
 - Maternity leave can begin up to **28 days before your expected due date**.

- The first **8 weeks (56 days) must be taken consecutively**. The remaining 16 weeks (80 working days) can be taken flexibly in daily increments over a 12-month period following the child's birth.
- Maternity leave must be logged in WorkWeek using two separate codes: *"Singapore Leaves > SG - Maternity Leave (First 8 weeks)"* and *"Singapore Leaves > SG - Maternity Leave (80 working days)"*.

2.2 Baby Bonding Leave (Global)

Baby Bonding Leave (BBL) is available to spent time with a new child welcomed through childbirth, adoption, surrogacy, or fostering (for parents who do not take maternity leave).

- **Allowance:** Eligible employees can take up to **18 weeks (90 work days) of paid leave** per year. Even if multiple children are welcomed at once, only one 18-week period can be claimed.
- **Timelines:** BBL must begin on or after the child's birth/placement date and be **fully utilized within 12 months** of that date, or any remaining balance is forfeited. It can be taken all at once or in weekly blocks.
- **Shared Parental Leave Impact (Singapore):** Your baby bonding leave remains at 18 weeks regardless of the SPL sharing arrangement with your spouse. However, if both parents are Altostrat employees and the father allocates SPL to his partner, his BBL must be reduced to 16 or 17 weeks depending on the allocation, subject to periodic audits.
- **Monetary Benefit:** Employees taking BBL are eligible for a monetary baby bonding benefit to spend on meals, cleaning, laundry, or gardening.
- **Administrative Coverage:** For planned medical leaves extending beyond a standard work week, employees are required to ensure business continuity. To do this, employees must open an administrative ticket (Category: 'HRSD', Priority: '3 - Moderate') to request a temporary email delegation to their direct manager.

2.3 Ramp-Back Time (Global)

To ease the transition back to work following a long leave, Altostrat offers ramp-back time.

- **Eligibility:** Employees must have taken **at least 10 consecutive weeks** of maternity, adoption, parental, or baby bonding leave.
- **Duration and Schedule:** You can take up to **2 weeks of paid ramp-back time** immediately upon your return. During these 2 weeks, you must work a

minimum of 50% of your normal weekly hours but will receive **100% of your normal salary**.

- **WorkWeek Entry:** Salaried employees must enter the hours not worked in WorkWeek under the type "*Ramp Back Time*" with the reason "*Baby Bonding Leave*". Hourly employees log this on their timecard in gTime.

SECTION 3: OTHER COMPASSIONATE & UNPAID LEAVES

3.1 Bereavement Leave (Global)

Paid bereavement leave is provided to support employees during times of grief.

- **Allowance:** Employees can take up to **4 weeks (20 work days for a standard 5-day schedule) of paid leave per event**. This applies to the loss of a close loved one, including pregnancy loss (miscarriage or stillbirth).
- **Timeline:** Bereavement leave must be taken **within 12 months of the death**.
- **Pet Loss:** Paid bereavement leave does not apply to pet loss. Vacation, unpaid time off, or flexible schedules should be arranged with managers in those instances.

3.2 Carer's Leave (Global)

- Eligible employees can take up to **8 weeks of paid leave per loved one** (family member, partner, dependent) **per lifetime** to care for seriously or terminally ill individuals.
- Leave is counted in work days and can be requested in weekly blocks or daily schedules. The minimum duration is **half a work day**.
- You may be asked to provide written attestation or medical documentation verifying the serious health condition. Do not share sensitive medical details when contacting support.

3.3 Unpaid Time Off & Personal Leave (Global)

When accrued vacation is exhausted or low, employees may request unpaid leaves of absence.

- **Unpaid Time Off (Short-Term):** With manager approval, you can take up to **30 calendar days of unpaid time off**. This can be taken continuously or in daily increments.
- **Personal Leave (Long-Term):** Requests to extend unpaid time off past 30 days reclassify the entire leave as a personal leave.
 - **Limits:** With manager and director approval, employees can request up to **92 calendar days of continuous unpaid personal leave** (inclusive of

any unpaid time off already taken). Personal leave must be taken in one continuous block.

- **Prerequisites:** You typically need **at least 2 years of tenure** and to have received a **"Significant Impact" or higher rating** in your last GRAD performance cycle to qualify.
- It is highly recommended that you have **fewer than 10 vacation days remaining** in your balance before unpaid leaves are approved. Personal leave cannot be used as a substitute for flexible work schedules or medical accommodations.

SECTION 4: TRAVEL & EXPENSE (T&E) GUIDELINES

4.1 Frugality & Booking Timelines

Employees are expected to keep travel frugal and spend Altostrat's money wisely.

- **Pre-Travel Checklist:** Discuss the trip with your manager, travel cap is 120USD per day for meals, create a ticket request as Travel from ITSM, and review the global risk map before departing.
- **Advance Booking:** Air and hotel bookings must be completed **at least 3 weeks in advance** to secure reasonable rates.

4.2 Corporate Cards (Company Card) & Expense Submission

- **Company Card Mandate:** Employees who incur significant business expenses (>\$10,000 per quarter) or single transactions **over \$5,000** must use their Company Card for their travel spend.
- **Submission Windows:** All travel expenses must be submitted through Concur **within 30 days** of the transaction or travel end date.
- **Aged Expense Approvals:**
 - Out-of-pocket claims older than 60 days require **Director approval**.
 - Claims older than 90 days require **VP approval**. Approvals must come from someone higher up the chain than your immediate manager.
 - Claims **older than one year are non-reimbursable**.

4.3 Lodging & Transportation Caps

- **Caps & Credits:** Flight and hotel choices are strictly subject to regional route caps.
- **Staying with Friends/Family:** Staying with a friend or relative in lieu of a hotel allows you to buy a host gift of **up to US \$50 per day**, backed by valid receipts. Cash or gift card host gifts are strictly prohibited.

- **Ground Transport:** Public transit or shared rides should be prioritized. Personal car use is reimbursable on a per-distance basis in Concur (which covers fuel; separate fuel expenses are prohibited). Car rentals must be midsize/intermediate or smaller.

4.4 Meal Allowances & Entertainment

- **Daily Meal Limit:** Reimbursement for individual meals on global business trips is capped at **US \$120 (or equivalent) per employee per day**. This is not a per diem; all meal expenses must be individually detailed with receipts.
- **Group Meals with Altostrat Colleagues:** Group meals are capped at **US \$120 per employee per day**.
 - You must list all attending colleagues in Concur for tax compliance.
 - **The most senior colleague present (highest level) must pay** and submit the expense to ensure independent manager approval.
- **VP Pre-Approval for High-Value Events:** Any group meal or customer entertainment event costing **US \$500 or greater per head** requires written, pre-event approval from your VP, which must be attached to the Concur expense report.
- **Non-Reimbursable Items:** Room movies, traffic/parking fines, and personal gifts are strictly non-reimbursable.

SECTION 5: ETHICS, COMPLIANCE, & CONDUCT perimeters

5.1 Anti-Bribery & Government Ethics

Altostrat has a strict zero-tolerance policy for bribery and corruption.

- **The Golden Rule:** Never offer, promise, give, or receive anything of value to/from a government official to obtain or retain an improper advantage. "Facilitation" or "grease" payments to expedite routine actions are strictly prohibited.
- **Definition of "Something of Value":** Cash, gift cards, meals, travel, lodging, offers of employment (including unpaid internships), and political/charitable contributions.
- **Written Pre-Approval Requirements (Risk, Compliance & Integrity - RCI team via go/governmentapproval):**
 - **U.S. Government Officials:** Written pre-approval is required **before offering anything of value** of any amount (except non-alcoholic drinks at an Altostrat office meeting).

- **Non-U.S. Government Officials:** Pre-approval is required if the value **exceeds US \$100**, or if cumulative courtesies to that official exceed US \$200 within a rolling 6-month period.
- **Government Organizations:** Donations of products, devices, or services of any value require pre-approval.
- **Record-Keeping Integrity:** All transactions must be recorded with absolute specificity. Never mask expenses using vague categories like "marketing". If a transaction involves a government official, you must list their name and check **"yes" to the "government-related" flag** on the PO or expense request.

5.2 Commercial Gifts & Entertainment (Non-Government Recipients)

- **Adult Entertainment & Gambling Prohibitions:** Business courtesies must never involve gambling, adult entertainment (strip clubs, hostess bars, room salons), cash, or cash equivalents (gift cards or certificates).
- **Frequency Limit:** You may not exchange business courtesies with the same customer or business partner **more than twice in any 3-month period** (excluding moderate, moderate-value entertainment events where both parties are in attendance).
- **Written Pre-Approval Thresholds (Non-Government):**
 - **Under US \$100 per person:** No pre-approval required.
 - **US \$100 to US \$250 per person:** Written pre-approval from the employee's **Manager**.
 - **US \$250 to US \$500 per person:** Written pre-approval from the employee's **Director** (or country manager).
 - **Over US \$500 per person:** Written pre-approval from the employee's **VP**.

5.3 Workplace Personal Relationships

Romantic, physical, or familial relationships can compromise professional objectivity and raise favoritism or harassment concerns.

- **Supervisory Prohibitions:** Romantic or physical relationships are **strictly prohibited** between employees where one individual is in a position to supervise or exercise authority over the other. This includes all reporting lines (including dotted lines) and project structures (such as Tech Leads or Cross-functional Leads supervising team members).
- **Candidates:** If you are in a relationship with an active job candidate, you must promptly disclose it to HR, recuse yourself from the hiring process, and ensure they are not hired into a role under your supervision.

- **VP Disclosure Mandate:** All employees at the **VP level or above must disclose any romantic, physical, or familial relationship** with any Altostrat employee, extended workforce member, or job candidate, regardless of reporting lines.
- **Reporting:** If an unpermitted relationship or conflict of interest structure exists, both parties and their managers must report it immediately to HR. Failure to report can lead to termination of employment.

5.4 Remote Work, Telework, & Data Security

- **Public Settings Restriction:** Do not work on Altostrat confidential or proprietary projects in public settings (such as coffee shops or public libraries).
- **Privacy Guardrails:** When working away from the office, you must use a privacy screen, wear headphones during virtual meetings, and keep sensitive documents physically secured.
- **Hybrid and Remote Work Arrangements**
 - **Hybrid Structure:** The hybrid work week is designed to offer flexibility in assigned office locations. Employees may work approximately three days a week in the office and two days away from the office (or nearby), or they may work fully remote. These arrangements may be considered telework in your location of employment.
 - **Local Compliance:** Hybrid work is an option globally, but local mandatory requirements that apply in certain locations will override the global policy content.
- **Working Time and Availability**
 - **Regular Hours:** While working away from the office, employees should generally remain available during their regular work hours. If you plan to adjust your schedule, you must inform your manager or open a case in ITSM.
 - **Statutory Limits:** Any applicable statutory work hour limits and minimum break requirements for your assigned office location remain the exact same during remote work
- **Data Protection and Privacy**
 - **Information Security:** Employees are expected to protect confidential and proprietary company and customer information in accordance with information security policies.
 - **Public Settings:** Employees must not work on confidential projects in public settings, such as coffee shops or public libraries.

- **Privacy Measures:** To maintain privacy when working on sensitive information away from the office, you must use a privacy screen, wear headphones during GVC meetings, and keep sensitive documents secured.
- **Corporate Monitoring:** The electronic monitoring and corporate systems policy applies equally whether you are working from the office, away from the office, or fully remote.
- **Internet Reimbursement:** Employees may be eligible for home internet reimbursement, subject to manager approval. Some countries may have additional statutory requirements for telework reimbursements.
- **Equipment:** Hardware (monitors, security keys,...) must open a case in ITSM (ServiceImmediately case) and get manager approval.
- **Home Office Equipment Allowance:** Employees with an approved 'Remote' or 'Hybrid' location status are eligible for a \$500 USD allowance for home office equipment, including monitors. All remote equipment orders must be submitted via a 'Facilities' category ticket and shipped directly to the employee's verified remote shipping address.
- **Risk Reporting:** Employees must inform their managers of any health and safety risks that may exist at their flexible working location. Employees and managers should discuss whether home working arrangements need to be changed to address these risks.

5.5 Community Guidelines (Conversational Boundaries)

Altostrat supports healthy, respectful, and open workplace discussion.

- **WorkWeek Productivity:** Disrupting the WorkWeek to engage in **raging debates over politics or non-work topics is prohibited**. Our primary responsibility is to do the work we were hired to do.
- **No Trolling:** Employees must not troll, name-call, or engage in ad hominem attacks against any coworker, business partner, or public figure. This includes any demeaning or humiliating remarks.
- **Relocation Allowance:** Employees transferring to international offices (such as the London HQ) are eligible for a relocation allowance capped at \$10,000 USD to cover moving and transition expenses. **Security & Access:** Transferring employees must request physical building badging pre-configuration for their destination office prior to their arrival. This must be initiated by opening a ticket (Category: 'Facilities', Priority: '3 - Moderate').
- **IT Service Management (ITSM) Guidelines Ticket Lifecycle:** All service tickets must progress sequentially through standard operational states (New → In Progress →

Resolved → Closed). Bypassing intermediate states (e.g., moving a ticket directly from New to Closed) is a compliance violation and is strictly prohibited. **Priority Definitions:** Ticket priority must accurately reflect the true business impact. Minor facility issues, such as a squeaky office chair or cosmetic wear, must be classified as '4 - Low'. Attempts to artificially inflate priority for non-emergencies will be programmatically downgraded.

SECTION 6: CONFIDENTIALITY, ASSETS, & FINANCIAL INTEGRITY

6.1 Preserving Confidentiality

Altostrat's innovations and culture rely on the strict protection of proprietary information.

- **Preventing Leaks:** Employees must never prematurely reveal confidential company information to the press or competitors, as this can harm product launches and eliminate competitive advantages.
- **Information Handling:** You must properly secure, label, and dispose of confidential material appropriately. All information classified as "Need to Know" or "Confidential" must be handled strictly according to data security guidelines.
- **Third-Party Disclosure:** Disclosure of confidential information to an outside party must only occur on an "only as needed" basis and strictly under a formally approved non-disclosure agreement (NDA). You must also safeguard any confidential information that Altostrat receives from partners under an NDA.
- **Former Employers:** You must not take advantage of a competitor's or former employer's confidential information.

6.2 Protecting Company Assets & Intellectual Property

- **Intellectual Property Rights:** Altostrat's trademarks, logos, copyrights, trade secrets, and patents are among our most valuable assets. Unauthorized use can lead to serious loss of value. You must never use the company's logos, marks, or protected property for any outside business or commercial venture without pre-clearance from Marketing.
- **Company Equipment:** Company funds, equipment, and other physical assets are provided to help you do your job effectively and must not be requisitioned for purely personal use.
- **Physical Security:** You must always secure your laptop and personal belongings, even while on company premises. Employees are required to wear their badge visibly while on site and must never tamper with or disable security and safety devices.

6.3 Financial Integrity & Contracting

Every employee plays a role in ensuring money is spent appropriately and financial records are accurate.

- **Spending Company Money:** Any expense submitted for reimbursement must be reasonable, directly related to company business, and supported by appropriate documentation. You must always accurately record the business purpose of the expense.
- **Signing Contracts:** Entering into a business transaction requires written documentation approved by the Legal Department. You must never sign a contract unless you are officially authorized to do so, it has been approved by Legal, and you have read and understood its terms.
- **Side Agreements Prohibited:** All contracts must be in writing and contain all relevant terms; Altostrat strictly prohibits any oral or written "side agreements".
- **Audits and Records:** You must never interfere with the auditing of financial records or falsify any record, including time reports and expense accounts.

6.4 Outside Employment & Business Ventures

- **Board Seats and Advisory Roles:** You must avoid accepting employment, advisory positions, or board seats with competitors or business partners if your judgment could be influenced in a way that harms the company. You are required to notify your manager before accepting a board seat with any outside company.
- **Starting a Business:** Employees must not start their own business if it will compete with the company.
- **Business Opportunities:** Any business opportunities discovered through your work here belong first to the company.

SECTION 7: HARASSMENT, DISCRIMINATION, & WORKPLACE CONDUCT

7.1 General Commitment and Applicability Altostrat has an unwavering commitment to maintaining a work environment that is free from sexual harassment, discrimination, misconduct, abusive conduct, and retaliation.

- **Scope:** This policy applies to applicants, employees, extended workforce members (temps, vendors, and contractors), customers, and visitors.
- **Settings:** The policy covers conduct at work, at work-related social events (such as off-sites and office parties), and conduct occurring on corporate networks and systems.
- **Consequences:** Employees who violate this policy face disciplinary action up to and including termination. Violations by extended workforce members or third parties may result in removal from the premises or termination of their business contracts.

7.2 Harassment and Sexual Harassment

- **Harassment:** Defined as unwelcome conduct based on a protected status that creates an intimidating, hostile, or abusive environment. This includes derogatory jokes, slurs, non-verbal staring or gestures, sharing offensive images, and unwanted bodily contact.
- **Sexual Harassment:** Defined as unwelcome conduct of a sexual nature. Prohibited behaviors include unwanted sexual advances, quid pro quo demands (making submission to conduct a condition of employment), displaying sexually explicit images, and unwanted physical contact like groping.
- **No Excuses:** Sexual harassment can occur regardless of the gender, gender identity, or orientation of the individuals involved. Claims that the behavior was "just a joke" or occurred because the individual was drinking alcohol are not acceptable excuses.

7.3 Discrimination & Protected Statuses

- **Prohibited Discrimination:** Altostrat strictly prohibits treating someone less favorably because of a protected status. This includes taking adverse actions such as intentionally reducing someone's performance score or denying a promotion based on these characteristics.
- **Protected Statuses:** At Altostrat, protected statuses include race, color, religion, veteran status, national origin, ancestry, pregnancy status, sex, gender identity or expression, age, marital status, mental or physical disability, medical condition, and sexual orientation.

7.4 Standards of Conduct & Bullying Employees are required to maintain basic standards of civility and respect toward one another, the extended workforce, and visitors.

- **Bullying:** Bullying involves repeated or serious one-off incidents of offensive, intimidating, or insulting behavior. This includes outbursts of aggression, spreading malicious rumors, and repeatedly shouting at or humiliating a colleague in front of others.
- **Doxxing and Privacy:** Disclosing a coworker's personal information—such as residential addresses, personal cell phone numbers, or financial information—without consent to subject them to abuse or harassment is strictly prohibited.
- **Additional Misconduct:** Other prohibited behaviors include violent threats, theft, insubordination, unethical behavior (such as falsifying records), accessing data without permission, possession of weapons, and excessive absenteeism (being absent for three or more days in a row without notice).

7.5 Retaliation

- **Strict Prohibition:** Altostrat strictly prohibits retaliation against any individual as a consequence of raising a concern, participating in an investigation, or assisting another employee in reporting a policy violation.

7.6 Reporting Concerns & Manager Obligations

- **How to Report:** Employees can raise concerns by speaking with their manager, Human Resources, the Respect@ team, or by filing an anonymous report through the Compliance Helpline. If a concern involves an executive (CEO, direct report to the CEO, or a Senior VP), it may be escalated to the Audit Committee of the Board of Directors.
- **Manager Responsibilities:** Managers are required to foster a safe environment and must promptly report any known or suspected policy violations to HR, the Respect@ team, or the Compliance Helpline. Failure by a manager to forward a complaint may result in discipline up to and including termination.
- **Investigations and Confidentiality:** All employees must cooperate and provide truthful information during workplace investigations. Providing false or misleading information is a policy violation. While the company treats inquiries as confidentially as possible by only disclosing information on a need-to-know basis, absolute confidentiality cannot be guaranteed.

SECTION 8: WORKPLACE PERSONAL RELATIONSHIPS

8.1 General Boundaries & Expectations Altostrat understands that co-workers and members of our extended workforce can quickly become a community of friends, but specific boundaries must be respected when pursuing or engaging in romantic, physical, or familial relationships.

- **Compliance:** In all relationships, employees are required to comply with the Code of Conduct, our values of respecting each other, and all policies against harassment, discrimination, and retaliation.
- **Consequences:** Failure to comply with the rules and reporting requirements set out in this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

8.2 Prohibited Supervisory Relationships: Relationships within the company may compromise an employee's ability to perform their job, create uncomfortable situations, and raise issues of fairness, favoritism, or harassment.

- **Positions of Authority:** Romantic or physical relationships are strictly prohibited between an employee and another employee or extended workforce member where one individual is in a position to supervise or exercise authority over the other.
- **Reporting Lines and Projects:** This prohibition applies to all reporting lines (including dotted-line reporting), cross-functional project teams, and Technical Lead roles where

one individual exercises supervision or authority, even without a direct reporting relationship.

- **Active Job Candidates:** If you are in a romantic or physical relationship with an active job candidate, you cannot participate in the hiring process and must promptly recuse yourself. If you supervise the role the candidate is applying for, you must inform HR to ensure the candidate is not hired into that specific role.

8.3 Familial Relationships

- **Scope:** Employees with familial relationships working at the company are subject to the exact same restrictions as those in romantic and physical relationships.
- **Definition:** A familial relationship includes a child, parent, in-law, grandparent, grandchild, sibling, aunt, uncle, cousin, nephew, niece, and anyone else whose relationship to you could impair (or be perceived as impairing) your objective judgment.

8.4 Permitted Relationships & Conflict Risks

- **General Allowance:** Relationships between employees (or extended workforce members) are generally permitted provided they are consensual, do not negatively impact the work environment, and do not create an actual or perceived conflict of interest.
- **Conflict of Interest Threshold:** A conflict exists if there are issues of unfairness, favoritism, or harassment, or if one person in the relationship would be expected to access salary information, performance reviews, or other confidential information about their partner as part of their job role.
- **High-Risk Scenarios:** Employees must understand that relationships carry a higher risk of creating conflicts or negative workplace impacts if the individuals are working on the same project or reporting to the same manager.

8.5 Mandatory Reporting & Disclosures

- **Employee Reporting:** If you are in a relationship or team structure that is not permitted, creates a conflict of interest, or causes a negative workplace impact, you must report it immediately to HR and/or your manager. Failure to promptly report prohibited relationships may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.
- **Manager Obligations:** If a manager becomes aware of a prohibited relationship, or one that causes a conflict or negative impact, they are required to report it promptly to HR, regardless of whether the relationship falls within their reporting line.
- **VP and Executive Disclosures:** All employees at the VP level or above are strictly required to disclose any romantic, physical, or familial relationship with anyone they

know to be an employee, extended workforce member, or active job candidate, regardless of reporting line or managerial authority. This data is shared with the Head of People Operations, the Chief Legal Officer, and reported on an aggregate basis to the Board of Directors.

8.6 Remediation Actions

- **Resolving Conflicts:** If a relationship is prohibited, or if HR/management assesses that it creates a conflict of interest or negative workplace impact, the company will take appropriate steps to address the situation.
- **Company Actions:** Remediation steps may include a transfer, reassignment, ending employment, or the termination of a business contract for one or both of the individuals involved.

Here is the drafted text for the new section based on the Community Guidelines. You can insert this into your Altostrat Singapore handbook as the next section (e.g., Section 9) to maintain the consistent formatting and tone.

SECTION 9: COMMUNITY GUIDELINES & WORKPLACE COMMUNICATIONS

9.1 General Principles and Expectations Community guidelines exist to support healthy and open discussion while maintaining an environment where employees can come together in pursuit of the company's shared mission. When communicating in the workplace, employees must remember the following:

- **Be responsible:** You are responsible for your words and actions and will be held accountable for them.
- **Be helpful:** Your voice is your contribution, and you must strive to make it productive.
- **Be thoughtful:** Your statements can be attributed to the company regardless of your intent, so you must be thoughtful to avoid causing others to make incorrect assumptions.
- **Company Values:** All communication must follow the three core values: respect the user, respect the opportunity, and respect each other.

9.2 WorkWeek Productivity & Disruptive Debates

- **Primary Responsibility:** An employee's primary responsibility is to do the work they were hired to do, not to spend working time engaging in debates about non-work topics.
- **Disruptive Conversations:** While sharing ideas builds community, disrupting the WorkWeek to have a raging debate over politics or the latest news story is prohibited.

Employees must avoid conversations that are disruptive or otherwise violate workplace policies.

- **Manager Obligations:** Managers are fully expected to address any discussions that violate these rules.

9.3 Respect, Belonging, and Anti-Trolling

- **Prohibited Behavior:** Employees must not troll, name-call, or engage in ad hominem attacks against anyone.
- **Insults and Demeaning Comments:** This prohibition specifically includes making statements that insult, demean, or humiliate other employees, members of the extended workforce, business partners, or public figures.

9.4 Accountability and Data Care

- **Debating Company Activities:** Employees are free to respectfully raise concerns, question, and debate the company's activities as part of the culture. However, you must speak with good information, avoid assuming you have the full story, and take care not to make false or misleading statements about products or the business that could undermine trust.
- **Information Dissemination:** Because workplace communications can be rapidly and broadly disseminated, you must never access, disclose, or disseminate "Need-to-Know" or "Confidential" information in violation of the Data Security Policy.

9.5 Reporting Violations

If you notice behavior that does not live up to these community guidelines, you have multiple options to address it:

- Speak up in the moment if you feel comfortable doing so.
- Report the inappropriate content by opening a case in ITSM or reach out to the group moderator when using internal platforms.
- Talk to an Advisor to discuss and explore your options.

SECTION 10: ALCOHOL, SMOKING, AND DRUGS

10.1 General Expectations Altostrat is committed to promoting a safe and productive working environment for all employees. Employees who are found to have violated the expectations related to alcohol, smoking, and drug consumption or distribution are subject to discipline, up to and including termination.

10.2 Alcohol Consumption

- **Conduct Standards:** While the consumption of alcohol is not banned at the company, employees are held to the exact same standards of conduct regardless of the presence of alcohol. Alcohol consumption is never an excuse for inappropriate conduct.
- **Excessive Consumption:** Excessive consumption of alcohol, as well as underage consumption, is strictly prohibited when you are at work, performing business, or attending a related event, whether onsite or offsite.
- **Manager and HR Responsibilities:** People managers are responsible for ensuring that company-sponsored events (both onsite and offsite) are safe. Managers must avoid encouraging overconsumption and are expected to address inappropriate conduct. HR is also responsible for responding if they become aware of excessive drinking or policy violations.

10.3 Smoking Guidelines

- **Prohibited Areas:** Smoking is prohibited in any part of the office at any time. This includes inside buildings, within posted distances outside entrances, and on company shuttles.
- **Devices Covered:** This prohibition includes the use of devices that resemble and operate like an actual cigarette, including cigars, e-cigarettes, and other vapor smoke devices.

10.4 Illegal Drugs & Controlled Substances

- **General Prohibition:** Consuming, possessing, manufacturing, distributing, or dispensing illegal controlled substances in our offices, facilities, or at work events is strictly prohibited globally at all times.
- **Convictions:** Employees must notify the company of any criminal drug statute conviction for a violation occurring in the workplace within five days of the conviction. Upon such a conviction, the company will discipline the offending employee and/or require them to participate in a drug abuse or rehabilitation program.
- **Marijuana Use:** Despite local or state laws, marijuana is classified as a US Drug Enforcement Administration Schedule I controlled substance; therefore, its consumption is strictly prohibited when at work, performing company business, or attending company-related events.

10.5 Prescription Medications

- **Permitted Use:** The lawful use and possession of over-the-counter or prescribed medications are permitted, provided they are used by the intended individual and only in the manner prescribed.

- **Safety Disclosures:** Employees must consult their doctors regarding a medication's effect on their fitness for duty and ability to work safely, and they must promptly disclose any work restrictions to their manager and the accommodations team.

10.6 Screenings, Reporting, and Support Resources

- **Screenings:** If there is reasonable suspicion that an employee is under the influence of drugs and/or alcohol in a manner that could adversely affect job performance or safety, the company may request a drug and/or alcohol screening as allowed under local law.
- **Reporting:** Employees are expected to help create a safe workplace culture and should speak up through the channels outlined in the Workplace Concern Policy if they observe inappropriate behavior.
- **Resources:** Altostrat recognizes that substance addiction can be an illness and provides resources to help, including referrals to drug counseling services, rehabilitation programs, and employee assistance programs (EAP).

SECTION 12: CONFLICTS OF INTEREST POLICY

12.1 Purpose and Definition

- **General Principle:** Employees and members of the extended workforce are expected to do what is best for the company.
- **Conflict Definition:** A conflict of interest arises when competing loyalties could cause an employee to pursue a benefit for themselves—or for individuals with whom they have a personal, financial, or close friend relationship—at the expense of the company or its users.
- **Impact:** A conflict (or even the appearance of one) may impair innovation, risk the disclosure of confidential information, taint intellectual property, or undermine public and user trust in the company's integrity.
- **Consequences:** Violations of this policy may result in discipline, up to and including termination of employment (or job assignment for extended workforce members).

12.2 Employee and Manager Obligations

- **Employee Requirements:** You must avoid circumstances that create a conflict of interest or the appearance of one. If you are subject to, or considering entering into, such circumstances, you must disclose it to your manager and seek review from Ethics and Business Integrity (EBI). You are also required to comply with any restrictions or mitigations set out by EBI.

- **Manager Requirements:** If a manager receives a disclosure or becomes aware of circumstances that may create a conflict (or the appearance of one), they must seek guidance from VP.

12.3 Examples of Conflicts of Interest

The following circumstances may create a conflict of interest (or the appearance of one) and must be disclosed:

- **Outside Work:** Engaging in outside work that involves a competitor or a competing product/service, or that overlaps with and impairs your current role.
- **Vendor and Supplier Relationships:** Having a personal, financial, or close friend relationship with a vendor/supplier (or a person there) when you are involved with their selection or management, or otherwise work with them.
- **Internal Relationships:** Having a personal relationship with another employee, extended workforce member, or active candidate where you exercise supervision or authority over them (as outlined in the Personal Relationships at Work policy).
- **External Relationships:** Having a personal, financial, or close friend relationship with an external customer/partner over whom you have influence in your job.
- **Investments:** Making or having a significant investment in a competitor, or in a company you work with or influence in your role. (Note: Trading securities while possessing material nonpublic information is subject to the Insider Trading Policy).
- **Corporate Resources:** Using corporate resources for personal financial gain, for a non-company business, or personally profiting from transactions based on your relationship with the company.
- **Internal Access:** Using internal tools, products, or confidential information to improperly benefit yourself or someone you know, or to create an unfair advantage over outside users.
- **Gifts and Entertainment:** Accepting personal gifts or entertainment from customers or suppliers, except when in strict compliance with the Anti-Bribery and Gifts policies.
- **Business Opportunities:** Exploiting business opportunities discovered through your work for a non-company purpose (unless otherwise agreed).
- **Former Government Employees:** Former government employees may be subject to special conflict of interest limitations regarding what they can do at the company.

12.4 Ethics and Business Integrity (EBI) Review

When EBI is notified of a potential conflict of interest, they will consult with relevant stakeholders to:

- Evaluate the circumstances and determine the risk of a conflict or its appearance.

- Recommend risk mitigations, which may include ceasing the conflicting activity, implementing an internal recusal, or taking other appropriate measures.

SECTION 13: ANTI-BRIBERY & GOVERNMENT ETHICS POLICY

13.1 General Prohibition & Core Principle

- **The Golden Rule:** Altostrat's anti-bribery policy is simple: don't bribe. Employees should never offer, give, or receive bribes in connection with company work to anyone at any time for any reason.
- **General Prohibition:** The company, its officers, employees, and third parties acting on its behalf cannot directly or indirectly give, offer, or promise anything of value to a government official with the corrupt intent to obtain or retain an improper advantage.
- **Facilitation Payments:** The policy strictly prohibits any "facilitation" or "grease" payments made to expedite routine, non-discretionary governmental actions (such as the issuance of permits, visas, or licenses), regardless of the amount.
- **Consequences:** Failure to comply may result in civil and criminal penalties for the company and the individuals involved, and is grounds for disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

13.2 Definitions

- **"Something of Value":** Includes cash or cash equivalents (e.g., gift cards/certificates or virtual money), gifts and entertainment, meals, travel and hotel, offers of employment (including internships), charitable and political contributions, and anything else of tangible or intangible value.
- **"Government Official":** Includes employees of national, state, and local governments; employees of government-owned or -controlled businesses (e.g., public universities, national telecom companies); employees of public international organizations (e.g., UN, World Bank); political parties and officials; candidates for public office; and members of royal families.

13.3 Pre-Approval Requirements Providing a business courtesy or modest gift to a government official can be permissible if it has a legitimate business purpose and is given transparently and infrequently. However, the following transactions require written pre-approval from the Risk, Compliance & Integrity (RCI) team via [case in ITSM](#):

- **U.S. Government Officials:** Before offering *anything* of value to any U.S. government official (regardless of value), except for offering non-alcoholic drinks in connection with a meeting hosted at a company office.

- **Non-U.S. Government Officials:** Before offering anything of value that exceeds US 100, *or if cumulative courtesies to that official exceed US200* within a rolling 6-month period.
- **Government Entities:** Before offering a contribution, donation, or gift of products, services, or money of any value to any governmental organization (e.g., devices to a Ministry of Education).
- **Political Contributions:** Before offering a corporate political contribution (monetary or in-kind) to any political organization, party, candidate, or committee. (This does not apply to purely personal political contributions unless RCI has provided specific guidance).
- **Hosting Events:** Before hosting or sponsoring an event where you have reason to believe government officials will receive anything of value that would otherwise require pre-approval.
- **Receiving Value:** Before receiving anything of value exceeding US\$100 from any government entity, official, or political party.

13.4 Strict Prohibitions on Business Courtesies Business courtesies/gifts cannot:

- Violate any laws or regulations.
- Be intended (or reasonably perceived as an attempt) to improperly influence official action.
- Embarrass or reflect negatively on the company's reputation (e.g., no "adult entertainment" or gambling).
- Be cash or a cash equivalent.

13.5 Third-Party Intermediaries and Due Diligence

- **Liability:** The company can be held criminally liable for the misconduct of its business partners.
- **Due Diligence:** All employees are responsible for ensuring that RCI due diligence procedures are completed for all intermediaries (e.g., business partners, consultants, resellers) who will interact with any government officials on the company's behalf. This due diligence must be initiated at **ITSM** and completed before the third party begins working.

13.6 Record-Keeping and Reporting

- **Transparency:** All transactions must be accurately recorded in the company's books and records with a reasonable level of specificity. You must never try to conceal the nature of a business courtesy (e.g., using vague categories like "marketing").

- **System Flags:** When submitting a PO or expense request, be sure to list the name of the government official involved and check "yes" to the question asking whether the PO or expense is "government-related".
- **Reporting:** If you become aware of a bribe being offered or requested, you are required to report it immediately either to RCI using a case in ITSM or to the anonymous helpline at [intranet](#).

SECTION 14: COMMERCIAL GIFTS & ENTERTAINMENT (NON-GOVERNMENT)

14.1 General Principles and Applicability

- **Scope:** This policy applies to all employees, temps, vendors, and contractors (TVCs) regarding business courtesies (gifts, entertainment, travel, meals) involving current or prospective non-government customers, suppliers, and partners. Failure to comply may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment or working arrangement.
- **Core Policy:** The policy is simple: do not bribe, and do not give or accept business courtesies that may create the appearance of a bribe. A bribe is defined as giving money, gifts, or something of value to improperly influence the actions or business decisions of the recipient. (For dealings with government officials, refer to the Anti-Bribery & Government Ethics Policy).

14.2 General Prohibitions Employees may not give or accept business courtesies that involve the following:

- **Illegal Activity:** Any illegal conduct or activity.
- **Gambling:** Gambling with customers, suppliers, or other business partners is prohibited, irrespective of whether participants are using their own money or company funds.
- **Adult Entertainment:** Adult entertainment is strictly prohibited, including but not limited to strip clubs, hostess bars, room salons, and/or venues where one can pay for sexual activity.
- **Cash and Cash Equivalents:** Cash is strictly prohibited, and cash equivalents (such as gift certificates, gift cards, or virtual money) are also prohibited except under limited circumstances allowed in the Gift Policy FAQs.
- **Onsite TVCs:** Employees are prohibited from giving swag or gifts (including cash) to onsite temporary staff, vendors, and contractors.

14.3 Frequency and Decision Factors

- **Frequency Limit:** As a general principle, employees should not give or accept business courtesies involving the same customer or business partner more than twice in any 3-month period.
- **Joint Entertainment:** When it comes to entertainment (such as meals or travel where both the employee and the partner are present), the frequency may exceed twice in 3 months as long as it is moderate and does not create an appearance of impropriety.
- **Evaluation Factors:** Before giving or accepting a courtesy, employees must evaluate several factors: whether there is a legitimate business purpose, the status of any current negotiations, the total market value and reasonableness of the courtesy, potential conflicts of interest, and whether the recipient is permitted to accept it under their own employer's policies.

14.4 Pre-Approval Requirements Business courtesies of more than US\$100 per person in value require written pre-approval because they may create an appearance of impropriety.

- **Under US\$100:** No pre-approval is required.
- **Over US\$100 *upto* US\$250:** Requires written pre-approval from the employee's manager.
- **Over US\$250 *upto* US\$500:** Requires written pre-approval from the employee's director (or country manager if there is no director in-country).
- **Over US\$500:** Requires written pre-approval from the employee's VP.

14.5 Purchasing Power Caution

- **Vendor Influence:** Employees who have the ability to influence company spending with a particular vendor or supplier must exercise particular caution.
- **Objective Decision-Making:** You must never accept a business courtesy if it would adversely impact your ability to make decisions in the company's best interest or create the appearance that it could do so.

SECTION 16: EMPLOYEE PRIVACY POLICY

16.1 Scope and Definition

- **Applicability:** This policy applies to all employees and those working at affiliates that do not have separate employee privacy policies.
- **Employee Data:** Employee Data means any information that identifies an employee or that can be used to identify an employee in the context of employment. This policy applies regardless of the format, media, or source of the Employee Data.

16.2 Types of Data Collected The company collects information provided by the employee as well as data generated from being recruited by, applying to, and working at the company. This includes:

- **Recruitment information:** Application and interview records, résumés or CVs, references, and background check information.
- **Personal details:** Contact information, bank and direct deposit details, government identification numbers, emergency contacts, family composition, and demographic information.
- **Performance, Compensation & Benefits:** Performance ratings and assessments, equity awards or stock, pension documents, payroll details, vacation records, and working time records.
- **Working data:** Survey data, disciplinary and grievance records, security recordings and badging records, logs, and usage data of company equipment, accounts, and systems.

16.3 Use of Employee Data

- **Business and Legal Purposes:** Employee Data is used for recruitment, compensation and payroll, performance assessment, talent management, surveys, legal compliance, and workplace management. It is also used to protect the company and workforce against injury, theft, or liability; to identify and investigate policy violations; to administer background checks; and to make employment decisions.
- **Technology Development:** The company may use Employee Data to help develop, train, fine-tune, and improve machine learning models and foundational technologies that power various products and internal tools, where it is in our legitimate interests to do so.
- **Sensitive Data:** Sensitive Employee Data (such as health, racial or ethnic origins, or sexual orientation) is only processed in limited circumstances. It is processed when necessary for legal claims, with your consent, or where required by local employment and social security laws (for example, using medical information to administer sick pay or using sexual orientation data to administer dependent benefits).

16.4 Data Security and Third-Party Sharing

- **Internal Access:** The company restricts the collection of and access to Employee Data to those entities and employees who need to access such data to carry out their assigned employment-related functions.
- **Employee Communication Rights:** Nothing in this policy limits any rights an employee may have in their personal capacity to share contact information or otherwise communicate about pay, hours, or other terms and conditions of working at the company with fellow employees or government agencies.
- **External Disclosures:** Employee Data may be disclosed beyond the company for business-related and legal purposes, such as to insurers, legal advisers, payroll providers, background check agencies, or government agencies to comply with mandatory reporting requirements.

- **Third-Party Requirements:** Any third parties (including temps, vendors, and contractors) processing Employee Data on the company's behalf must use it only as directed, protect it in accordance with applicable data protection regulations, and refrain from unauthorized disclosures.

16.5 Retention and Employee Privacy Rights

- **Retention:** Employee Data is kept for as long as it is needed for the purposes outlined above. Employment records are generally maintained for the period of employment, and after you leave, they are kept as needed to protect against legal claims and satisfy compliance obligations (which may depend on local laws).
- **Employee Rights:** Depending on the country, employees have the right to request access, correction, amendment, anonymization, or deletion of certain Employee Data, as well as the right to object to or restrict its processing.
- **Access Exceptions:** Exceptions to the right to access may include confidential or proprietary data (such as talent planning data), instances where disclosure would violate the privacy rights of others, ongoing investigations of malfeasance, or where disclosure would prejudice the company's interests in litigation.

16.6 International Data Transfers

- **Global Processing:** Because the company operates globally, Employee Data may be processed outside the country or region where you are located, including processing in the United States.
- **Compliance Mechanisms:** To ensure data is adequately protected during international transfers, the company relies on European Commission/UK/Swiss Adequacy Decisions, the EU-U.S. and Swiss-U.S. Data Privacy Frameworks (DPF), and Standard Contractual Clauses (SCCs).

16.7 Inquiries and Complaints

- For general employment-related questions, contact HR.
- To exercise privacy rights or make a complaint, reach out to [your Manager or HR or open a case ITSM](#).
- You can also contact the Data Protection Officer at abc@altostrat.com or raise questions and concerns with your manager or open a case in ITSM.

SECTION 17: FLEXIBLE WORK REQUESTS (SINGAPORE)

17.1 Applicability and Scope

- **Eligibility:** This procedure applies exclusively to company employees; it does not apply to temporary staff, vendors, or contractors.

- **Policy Status:** This procedure does not form part of your contract of employment with the company and may be amended at any time.

17.2 Definition of a Flexible Working Request A flexible working request under this policy generally means a request to do any or all of the following:

- Reduce or vary your working hours.
- Reduce or vary the days you work.
- Work from a different location (for example, from home).
- Any combination of the above arrangements.

17.3 Submission Process and Timelines

- **Making a Request:** To request flexible work, you must be a current employee at the date of your request.
- **Written Submission:** Your flexible work request must be submitted formally in writing via email to your Manager or open a HR case in ITSM.
- **Decision Timeline:** Once your written request is submitted, the company will evaluate it and inform you of the decision within 2 months.

SECTION 18: UNPAID TIME OFF & PERSONAL LEAVE

18.1 Eligibility and Applicability

- **Eligible Employees:** Full-time, part-time, and fixed-term employees are eligible to take both unpaid time off and personal leave.
- **Interns and Apprentices:** Interns and apprentices are only eligible to take unpaid time off, and they may not take personal leave.

18.2 Unpaid Time Off (Up to 30 Days)

- **Allowance and Increments:** With manager approval, eligible employees can take up to 30 calendar days of unpaid time off. This time can be taken continuously or in daily increments. For part-time employees, the unpaid time off is prorated based on their work schedule.
- **Extensions:** If an employee chooses to extend their unpaid leave to more than 30 continuous calendar days, they must file a new request, and the entire leave will be reclassified as a personal leave if approved.
- **Booking:** After receiving verbal or written manager approval, the employee must enter their unpaid time off in WorkWeek.

18.3 Personal Leave (Up to 92 Days)

- **Allowance:** With both manager and director approval, employees can take up to 92 calendar days of continuous unpaid personal leave, which is inclusive of any unpaid time off already taken.
- **Usage Rules:** Personal leave must be taken in one continuous block of time. Vacation can only be added before or after the personal leave if the employee wants to extend their time away.
- **Prerequisites:** It is recommended that employees use all available leaves, such as accrued vacation, medical leave, and carer's leave, before applying for a personal leave.
- **Approval Criteria:** Applications are evaluated based on past performance and current team needs, and are granted on a case-by-case basis at the business's discretion. Managers and directors may consider factors such as having at least 2 years of tenure, receiving a "Significant Impact" or higher rating in the last cycle, having fewer than 10 vacation days remaining, and the team's ability to cover the work in the employee's absence.
- **Notice and Booking:** Employees must notify their manager at least 30 days in advance of the requested leave. To book the leave, the employee must contact support to submit the manager and director approvals so that People Ops can enter the personal leave in WorkWeek on their behalf.

18.4 Unpaid Compassionate Leave

- **Allowance:** For serious personal reasons—such as caring for a seriously or terminally ill loved one, grieving a loss, or dealing with a major family transition (like divorce or relationship breakdown)—employees may be able to take up to 92 calendar days of continuous unpaid compassionate leave.
- **Approvals and Limitations:** This leave requires manager and/or director approval and includes any unpaid time off already taken. Unpaid compassionate leave cannot be stacked with unpaid personal leave.

18.5 Conditions During Leave

- **Compensation and Taxes:** Employees will not be paid during unpaid time off or personal leave, including for any holidays that take place during the leave. Employees may remain liable for income tax on continuing benefits and insurances, which the company will deduct from the first paycheck upon their return.
- **Systems and Office Access:** The company encourages employees to focus on their leave and keep office visits to a minimum, outside of pre-arranged wellness services. Access to corporate systems should be minimal; the company reserves the right to suspend access if an employee accesses systems regularly or attempts to perform work.

- **Intellectual Property:** Employees remain subject to their employment contract and the Confidential Information and Invention Assignment Agreement while on leave. Any intellectual property created during the leave belongs to the company unless specific exceptions described in the agreement apply.
- **Visa Restrictions:** Visa holders may face restrictions on the amount of unpaid leave they can take and must contact the immigration team to understand whether taking unpaid leave could impact their immigration status.

18.6 Inappropriate Use of Leave

- **Substitutions:** Unpaid time off and personal leave should not be used as a substitute for a flexible work arrangement or a workplace accommodation required by a physician.
- **Outside Work:** These leaves are not for the purpose of starting a business or working for someone else. Exceptions are granted at the company's sole discretion, are generally reserved for business-critical situations, and require approval from the VP, manager, and the Ethics and Compliance team prior to the start of the leave or outside employment.

SECTION 19: SICK TIME & HOSPITALIZATION LEAVE (SINGAPORE)

19.1 Eligibility and Scope

- **Eligible Personnel:** Singapore-based employees and interns are eligible for paid sick leave if they are sick or a doctor certifies they are unfit for work.
- **Ineligible Personnel:** Temps, vendors, and contractors are not eligible for this policy and must contact their direct employer to understand their benefits.
- **Statutory Compliance:** This policy is inclusive of all local statutory leave entitlements. Part-time and fixed-term employees will have their time off prorated according to their working hours.

19.2 Outpatient Sick Leave

- **Allowance:** Eligible employees can take up to 14 days of paid sick leave per year compensated at 100% of their base salary. Leave is counted in work days based on your regular work schedule.

19.3 Hospitalization Leave Employees can use an additional 46 work days of hospitalization leave. To use this leave, you must contact support and meet one of the following criteria:

1. You are warded in a hospital as an inpatient or for day surgery.
2. You are under quarantine (whether or not in a hospital) under any written law.

3. You are ill enough to require hospitalization during the leave period (must be certified by a medical practitioner).
4. You need rest or further medical treatment during the leave period after discharging from a hospital (must be certified by a medical practitioner).
- **Certification Requirements:** You must provide a sick certificate indicating the hospitalization leave period, issued by a registered medical practitioner who can admit patients into hospitals. For reasons (3) and (4) above, the certifying medical practitioner must be employed by a hospital approved by the Minister for Manpower; otherwise, the company reserves the right to request more information before approving the leave.
- **Discretionary Approval:** Paid hospitalization leave is not an automatic extension of paid outpatient sick leave. It is discretionary, based on business approval, and granted on a case-by-case basis.

19.4 Notification and Medical Certificates (MC)

- **Notifying Your Manager:** You must tell your manager that you need to take sick or hospitalization leave at least one hour before your normal start time. If your manager is unavailable, you must contact support. You must also notify your manager of your expected return-to-work date.
- **MC Submission:** If you are sick for more than two work days, you must submit your sick certificate from a registered medical practitioner through WorkWeek. This certificate must be submitted within 48 hours. The company reserves the right to decline your sick leave if the certificate is not submitted.
- **System Recording:** It is critical that you enter your sick time in WorkWeek, even if your team has a separate leave calendar, to ensure proper support and payment.
- **Unapproved Absences:** If you do not inform the company of your reason for absence, you will be considered absent without approval and may not be paid. Unapproved absences can result in disciplinary action.

19.5 Medical and Health Appointments

- **Scheduling:** You can schedule medical and health-related appointments during work hours for a reasonable amount of time. You must tell your manager as soon as you can and agree on how long you will need to be away from work.
- **Logging Time:** Depending on the duration of the appointment, you may be asked to log the time as sick leave in WorkWeek and provide a sick certificate confirming the appointment details.

19.6 Compensation, Benefits, and Systems During Leave

- **Pay and Vesting:** During approved sick leave, your salary will continue as if you were working your normal hours, and stock will continue to vest as normal.
- **Accruals and Holidays:** You will continue to accrue vacation as normal. You do not have to apply for sick leave if you fall sick during public holidays, unless the public holiday is a working day for you.
- **Benefits:** Medical, life, travel, and disability insurance, as well as retirement contributions, gym reimbursement, and internet reimbursement, will continue as normal during your leave.
- **System Access:** The company encourages you to focus on your leave and recovery. Access to corporate systems should be minimal; if you access systems regularly or attempt to perform work, the company has the right to suspend your access.
- **Intellectual Property:** Any intellectual property you create during a leave will belong to the company, unless it falls within the exceptions described in your signed agreements.

19.7 Excessive Usage & Disciplinary Action

- **Monitoring:** The company monitors the amount of sick time taken by employees. If you have repeated, regular, or high levels of absence, the company will discuss it with you to resolve the situation.
- **Assessments:** You may be asked to seek specific medical advice, attend a medical assessment, or submit medical certificates from the first day of each new absence period.
- **Misuse:** Sick time should only be used when you are medically unfit for work and should not be used to supplement vacation or public holidays. Excessive or incorrect usage may result in an investigation and disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal.

19.8 Leaving or Transferring

- **No Payouts:** If you leave the company or transfer to another location, your leave stops on your End Date. You will not be paid out for any unused sick leave or hospitalization leave.
- **No Transfers:** If transferring to another location, your sick leave and hospitalization leave balances will not transfer to the new location.

Here is the drafted text for the new section based on the "Vacation (Singapore)" document. You can insert this into your Altostrat Singapore handbook as the next section (e.g., Section 20) to maintain consistent formatting and tone.

SECTION 20: VACATION LEAVE (SINGAPORE)

20.1 Eligibility

- **Eligible Personnel:** Full-time, part-time, and fixed-term Singapore-based employees, apprentices, and interns are eligible for vacation time.
- **Ineligible Personnel:** Temps, vendors, and contractors are not eligible for this policy and should contact their direct employer to understand their benefits.

20.2 Accrual Rates and Increments

- **Annual Allotment:** Employees earn their full amount of vacation for the year on January 1. The number of days accrued depends on the length of continuous service:
 - 1 to 6 years of service: 20 days.
 - 7 to 10 years of service: 21 days.
 - 11 years and above of service: 22 days.
- **Proration:** In your first year as an employee, you will earn a prorated number of vacation days based on your start date. Part-time and fixed-term employees accrue prorated vacation hours based on their individual working schedule or FTE percentage.
- **Booking Increments:** You can take vacation in half- or full-days.
- **Shift Workers:** A vacation day is defined as 8 hours. If you are scheduled to work shifts longer than 8 hours, you must take vacation based on the actual number of hours of your shift (for example, a 12-hour shift requires taking 1.5 vacation days).

20.3 Carryover and Payouts

- **Carryover Limits:** All unused vacation days for the current year will carry over for exactly one additional year. Carried-over vacation days must be used before the end of the following year, or you will lose them.
- **No Cash-Out:** The company does not pay out unused vacation to ensure employees take regular breaks to relax and recharge. Exceptions are only made for employees who are transferring to another country or leaving the company entirely.
- **Negative Balances:** If you took more vacation than you earned at the time you leave or transfer, the excess will be deducted from your final paycheck.

20.4 Requesting and Modifying Leave

- **Advance Notice:** You must discuss and obtain approval from your manager for your planned vacation dates at least 15 days in advance.
- **Changes and Cancellations:** You must change or cancel your vacation at least 15 days before it starts.
- **System Recording:** Once you have your manager's approval, you must enter your vacation leave in WorkWeek or gTime.

20.5 Compensation and Benefits During Leave

- **Pay and Bonuses:** Your salary will continue as if you were working your normal hours, and there is no impact on your company bonus (which is calculated as usual based on your GRAD rating).
- **Equity and Insurance:** Stock will continue to vest as normal during your leave. Health, life, long-term disability, and travel insurance, as well as retirement contributions, will continue normally.
- **Perks:** Gym reimbursements and home internet reimbursements continue while you are on leave.
- **Public Holidays:** Your leave will not be extended by any public holidays that occur during your vacation.

20.6 Floating Holidays

- **Earning:** If a public holiday falls on a Saturday or Sunday, you receive a floating holiday.
- **Usage:** You must use these days like vacation anytime before the calendar year ends.
- **Restrictions:** Floating holidays will not be carried forward to the following year and are not cashed out upon transfer or termination. Employees are recommended to use floating holidays before their standard vacation balance.

SECTION 21: GLOBAL LEAVES OVERVIEW

21.1 General Overview

- **Availability:** This section provides a high-level overview of the leaves available globally across the company.
- **Local Variations:** The exact length and payment attached to each leave may vary by country, and other local statutory leaves may also be available depending on your location.

21.2 Standard Paid Time Off

- **Vacation:** Vacation is paid time off provided for employees to rest, relax, and spend time with friends and family. Employees can find and track their accrued vacation time directly in WorkWeek.
- **Public Holidays:** Each work location observes certain company-recognized paid public holidays. If you observe a religious holiday that does not fall on a standard public holiday, you can take vacation or unpaid time off if you do not have enough vacation accrued.

21.3 Health and Care Leaves

- **Sick Time/Leave:** Sick time is paid time off provided to allow employees to recover from an illness or injury. It is important to take sick time if you need to support your health, and you do not have to tell your manager or team the specific medical reason for your sick time.
- **Carer's Leave:** Carer's leave is paid leave provided to care for a seriously ill family member or loved one. Employees can use other leaves or flexibility arrangements to extend their career's leave if necessary.

21.4 Family-Building and Transition Leaves

- **Maternity Leave:** Maternity leave provides approximately 24 weeks at 100% pay for pregnancy, childbirth, and infant bonding.
- **Baby Bonding Leave:** Baby bonding leave provides 18 weeks at 100% pay for the early care of a new child. This leave can be taken in one-week increments within the first year of the child's birth or adoption.
- **Ramp-Back Time:** Ramp-back time provides 2 weeks at 100% pay, while only working 50% time, to help ease the transition back to work following maternity or baby bonding leave while balancing work and new childcare arrangements.
 - To be eligible, you must take at least 10 or more consecutive weeks of bonding or maternity leave.
 - Ramp-back time must be taken immediately upon your return to work.
 - You can customize your working schedule for those 2 weeks as long as you work a minimum of 50% of your normal working hours.

21.5 Unpaid and Personal Leaves

- **Unpaid Time Off:** Unpaid time off is unpaid leave that lasts for 30 calendar days or less. This is used when extra leave is needed beyond other available leaves, such as to extend baby bonding leave or if your vacation balance is exhausted or low.
- **Personal Leave:** Personal leave is unpaid leave that lasts 31 calendar days or more, but less than 90 calendar days. This is used when extra time away is needed beyond other available leaves for reasons such as extending baby bonding leave, studying, or traveling.

SECTION 22: BEREAVEMENT LEAVE (GLOBAL)

22.1 General Scope and Eligibility

- **Purpose:** If someone close to you passes away, you can take paid bereavement leave to grieve and support your loved ones. This includes if your family loses a child through miscarriage or stillbirth.

- **Pet Loss:** Paid bereavement leave does not apply to the loss of a pet or animal companion; instead, you can work with your manager to schedule vacation, unpaid time off, or a temporary flexible working schedule.
- **Eligible Personnel:** Full-time and part-time employees are eligible.
- **Ineligible Personnel:** Apprentices and interns are not eligible under this policy, but may be entitled to statutory bereavement leave based on their location. Temps, vendors, and contractors are not eligible and must contact their employer directly.

22.2 Allowance and Timelines

- **Duration:** You can take up to 4 weeks of paid bereavement leave per event. Leave is counted in work days based on your regular work schedule (for example, if you work 40 hours over 5 days per week, you can take up to 20 work days). The 4 weeks offered are inclusive of all local leave requirements.
- **Timeline:** Bereavement leave must be taken within 12 months of a death. Exceptions may be possible where religious, spiritual, or cultural practices require funeral rites or rituals to take place at a later time.

22.3 Requesting Leave and System Access

- **Notification:** You should contact your manager (or support) to discuss your situation and share details including your leave or flexibility needs, as well as any time needed for travel.
- **System Access and Office Visits:** The company encourages you to focus on your leave. You should keep office visits to a minimum and access to corporate systems should be minimal. If you access corporate systems regularly or attempt to perform work, the company has the right to suspend your access.
- **Intellectual Property:** You remain an employee while on leave, and any intellectual property you create during a leave will belong to the company (unless it falls within exceptions described in your signed agreements).

22.4 Compensation, Benefits, and Performance

- **Pay:** Your salary and benefits will continue as if you were working your normal hours, and you remain responsible for any benefits deductions.
- **Adjusting Expectations:** Loss can have a profound effect on someone's capacity, even after returning to work. Employees and managers should document adjusted expectations that are scaled to the individual's changed capacity after the bereavement event.

22.5 Support and Returning to Work

- **Counseling and Peer Support:** Employees and their dependents can access confidential counseling through the Employee Assistance Program (EAP) provider, Lyra. Peer support spaces are also available for bereaved co-workers, parents who have lost a child, and general mental health awareness.
- **Returning:** You must notify your manager of your return-to-work date. If you do not plan on returning, you must give notice of termination as required by your employment contract.

SECTION 23: CARER'S LEAVE (GLOBAL)

23.1 Purpose and Eligibility

- **Purpose:** Employees can take carer's leave to care or arrange care for people close to them who are seriously or terminally ill, including family members, partners, and dependents.
- **Eligible Personnel:** Full-time and part-time employees are eligible.
- **Ineligible Personnel:** Apprentices and interns are not eligible. Temps, vendors, and contractors are also not eligible for this policy and should contact their employer directly to understand their benefits.

23.2 Leave Allowance and Increments

- **Duration:** You can take up to 8 weeks of paid leave for each loved one (family member, partners, and dependents) per lifetime for serious and terminal illnesses.
- **Increments:** Leave is counted in work days based on your regular work schedule. You can request this leave in weekly blocks (a continuous period of time) or in daily schedules (for example, once per week for a period of time). The minimum duration is half a work day.
- **Proration:** If you are part-time, your time off will be prorated according to your percentage FTE (for example, if you work 50% FTE, you can take up to 20 leave days).

23.3 Attestation and Requesting Leave

- **Attestation:** You may be asked to acknowledge in writing that you are needed to provide the necessary care or comfort to a loved one with a serious or terminal illness or health condition. The company reserves the right to request medical provider documentation confirming this care.
- **Request Process:** You must contact your manager to discuss your situation. After this discussion, either you or your manager should contact support with your leave/flexibility needs (including exact dates) and your relationship to the person you are caring for.

- **Privacy Guardrail:** You must *not* share any medical information when you contact support. Once approved, your leave will be entered in WorkWeek for you.

23.4 Compensation and Benefits During Leave

- **Pay and Equity:** Your salary will continue as if you were working your normal hours, and stock will continue to vest as normal during your leave.
- **Accruals and Holidays:** You will continue to accrue vacation as normal during your leave. If there is a company holiday, you should not schedule a carer's leave day for that day.
- **Benefits:** Your medical, life, travel, and disability insurance, as well as retirement contributions, will continue as normal. You will continue to be responsible for any benefits deductions, which will be deducted as normal from your leave pay.
- **Perks:** Gym benefits, commuter benefits, company-paid cell phone reimbursements, and internet reimbursement will continue while you are on leave.

23.5 Conduct and Systems Access

- **Focus on Leave:** The company encourages you to focus on your leave and keep office visits to a minimum.
- **System Access:** Access to corporate systems should be minimal while on leave. If you access corporate systems regularly or attempt to perform work, the company has the right to suspend your access.
- **Intellectual Property:** You remain an employee while on leave and are subject to your employment contract and Confidential Information and Invention Assignment Agreement. Any intellectual property you create during a leave will belong to the company, unless it falls within the exceptions described in the agreement.

23.6 Returning and Separations

- **Returning:** You must notify your manager of your return-to-work date. If you do not plan on coming back to work or are unsure, you must discuss it with your manager and contact support as soon as possible.
- **Separations:** If you leave the company, your carer's leave stops on your End Date, and you will not be paid out for any unused carer's leave.

SECTION 24: CHILDCARE LEAVE (SINGAPORE)

24.1 Eligibility and Scope

- **Eligible Personnel:** Full-time, part-time, and fixed-term Singapore-based employees, apprentices, and interns are eligible for childcare leave.

- **Ineligible Personnel:** Temps, vendors, and contractors are not eligible for this policy and should contact their employer directly to understand their benefits.
- **Statutory Compliance:** This policy and the company's leave benefit are inclusive of all local statutory leave entitlements.

24.2 Leave Allowance The company offers paid childcare leave for parents with children under the age of 12.

- **Children under 7 years old:** You can take up to 6 days of paid leave per year.
- **Youngest child 7-12 years old:** You can take up to 2 days of paid leave per year.
- **Children in both age groups:** You can take up to 6 days of paid leave per year.
- **Increments:** Leave is counted in full work days based on your regular work schedule.

24.3 Requesting Leave

- **Manager Approval:** You must contact your manager to discuss your leave and agree on your leave dates.
- **System Recording:** Once you have informed your manager or support, you must enter your childcare leave in WorkWeek. Your manager will be notified that you have booked leave.

24.4 Conditions During Leave

- **Compensation and Equity:** Your salary will continue as if you were working your normal hours, and stock will continue to vest as normal during your leave.
- **Accruals and Holidays:** You will continue to accrue vacation as normal. If you need childcare on a public holiday, you do not have to apply for the leave unless that public holiday is a working day.
- **Benefits:** Health, life, long-term disability, and travel insurance, as well as retirement contributions, gym reimbursement, and internet reimbursement, will continue as normal.
- **System Access:** The company encourages you to focus on your leave and keep office visits to a minimum. Access to corporate systems should be minimal; if you access systems regularly or attempt to perform work, the company has the right to suspend your access.
- **Intellectual Property:** You remain an employee while on leave, and any intellectual property you create will belong to the company, unless it falls within the exceptions described in your signed agreements.
- **Returning to Work:** You must notify your manager of your return-to-work date.

24.5 Separations and Transfers

- **Leaving the Company:** If you leave the company, your leave stops on your End Date. You will not be paid out for any unused childcare leave.
- **Transfers:** If you are transferring to another country, you must visit the benefits portal to learn about your new leave entitlements.

SECTION 25: TIME OFF IN LIEU (SINGAPORE)

25.1 Eligibility and Scope

- **Eligible Personnel:** Full-time, part-time, and fixed-term Singapore-based employees and interns are eligible for time off in lieu.
- **Ineligible Personnel:** Temps, vendors, and contractors are not eligible for this policy and should contact their direct employer to understand their benefits.
- **Statutory Compliance:** This policy and the company's leave benefit are inclusive of all local statutory leave entitlements.

25.2 Earning Time Off in Lieu (TOIL)

- **Qualifying Work:** If you are required to work on a public holiday or during the weekend, you can claim time off in lieu to compensate for working outside your contractual hours.
- **Manager Discretion:** Time off in lieu is taken at your manager's discretion. If you feel you have a case for time off in lieu—such as having worked on a public holiday when the business required it—you must talk to your manager.

25.3 Requesting and Logging TOIL

- **Manager Agreement:** You must talk to your manager to agree on the dates for your time off in lieu.
- **Usage Order:** You must use your time off in lieu days *before* logging any additional vacation days.
- **System Recording:** Unlike standard vacation, there is no need to log time off in lieu in WorkWeek.

SECTION 26: BABY BONDING LEAVE (GLOBAL)

26.1 Purpose and Eligibility

- **Purpose:** If you have a new child through childbirth, adoption, surrogacy, or fostering, you can take paid leave to spend time with your new child. (Note: This policy does not apply to birth-giving parents, who should review the maternity/new parent leave policy instead).

- **Eligible Personnel:** Full-time, part-time, and fixed-term global employees are eligible if they are an expectant parent (through adoption, surrogacy, or fostering) or the partner of an expectant parent.
- **Ineligible Personnel:** Apprentices, interns, temps, vendors, and contractors are not eligible for this policy.

26.2 Leave Allowance and Timelines

- **Duration:** Eligible employees can take up to 18 weeks (90 work days) of paid leave per year. This leave is inclusive of all local statutory leave entitlements, such as statutory paternity leave.
- **Multiples:** If you welcome multiple children at the same time (e.g., birth of multiples or simultaneous adoptions), you can take only one 18-week period of bonding leave.
- **Timeline:** Leave can start on or after your child's birth, adoption, or foster placement date. You must use all 18 weeks of leave within 12 months of that date; any remaining leave will be lost.
- **Increments:** Leave is counted in work days based on your regular schedule, and you can take it all at once or in weekly blocks.

26.3 Singapore Shared Parental Leave (SPL) Scenarios Effective April 1, 2026, the Singapore SPL scheme provides 10 weeks of parental leave. The company's 18-week Baby Bonding Leave is inclusive of these statutory entitlements.

- **Googler Father + Non-Googler Mother:** The father's total entitlement remains 18 weeks, regardless of how the SPL is shared.
- **Non-Googler Father + Googler Mother:** If the partner donates 9 or 10 weeks of SPL, the mother's Maternity Leave may be extended to 25 or 26 weeks.
- **Both Parents are Googlers:** If the birthing parent utilizes SPL to extend their Maternity Leave, the father's Baby Bonding Leave remains 18 weeks and is not reduced. Conversely, if the birthing parent donates SPL to the father, the father's Baby Bonding Leave remains 18 weeks and the birthing parent's Maternity Leave remains 24 weeks.
- **Verification:** To ensure compliance, you must submit your SPL arrangement via LifeSG and provide a copy to the company for verification.

26.4 Requesting and Modifying Leave

- **Notice:** You must provide your manager with at least 4 weeks of notice where possible.
- **System Recording:** Once aligned with your manager, enter your baby bonding leave in WorkWeek or gTime.

- **Documentation:** While documentation isn't required when requesting in WorkWeek, the company reserves the right to request relevant documentation later, such as a birth or adoption certificate.

26.5 Compensation and Benefits During Leave

- **Pay and Equity:** Your salary will continue as if you were working your normal hours, and stock will continue to vest as normal.
- **Accruals and Holidays:** You will continue to accrue vacation as normal. In select locations, your leave will not be extended by public holidays that occur during your leave; instead, you get extra days in your balance to use later.
- **Benefits:** Your enrolled benefits, gym benefits, company-paid cell phone reimbursements, and internet reimbursement will continue as normal.
- **Baby Bonding Benefit:** You are eligible for a monetary baby bonding benefit to spend on meals, house cleaning, diaper, laundry, or gardening services.

26.6 Conduct and Returning to Work

- **System Access:** The company encourages you to focus on your leave. Access to corporate systems should be minimal, and the company has the right to suspend access if you attempt to perform work regularly.
- **Returning:** You must notify your manager of your return-to-work date. If you take at least 10 consecutive weeks of baby bonding leave, you are eligible for ramp-back time.

SECTION 27: MATERNITY LEAVE (SINGAPORE)

27.1 Eligibility and Scope

- **Eligible Personnel:** Full-time, part-time, and fixed-term Singapore-based employees and interns are eligible.
- **Ineligible Personnel:** Temps, vendors, and contractors are not eligible for this policy and should contact their employer directly to understand their benefits.
- **Statutory Compliance:** This policy and the company's leave benefit are inclusive of all local statutory leave entitlements for birthing mothers.

27.2 Duration and Shared Parental Leave (SPL)

- **Standard Allowance:** Effective April 1, 2026, all eligible employees are entitled to 24 weeks of paid maternity leave.
- **SPL Extension:** If your child is a Singapore citizen, you can receive up to 26 weeks of paid parental leave if your spouse donates their full 10 weeks of the Shared Parental Leave (SPL) scheme to you. (The default SPL split is 5 weeks for mothers and 5 weeks for fathers).

- **SPL Scenarios (For Singapore Citizen Children born on or after April 1, 2026):**
 - **Employee (Mother) + Non-Employee (Father):** You are entitled to 24 weeks standard. If your spouse donates 9 or 10 weeks of his SPL to you, your leave increases to 25 or 26 weeks. If you donate 9 or 10 weeks of SPL to your spouse, your maternity leave will remain 24 weeks because the company's benefit already exceeds statutory limits.
 - **Both Parents are Employees:** The mother receives 24 weeks of Maternity Leave and the spouse receives 18 weeks of Baby Bonding Leave. If the mother receives 9 or 10 weeks of SPL from her spouse, her leave extends to 25 or 26 weeks. However, employee fathers allocating 9 or 10 weeks of SPL to their partner will need to reduce their Baby Bonding Leave to 16 or 17 weeks, subject to periodic audits.
- **Verification:** Regardless of the sharing arrangement, you are required to provide proof of the official SPL allocation from LifeSG within 4 weeks from your child's birth or adoption date. The company reserves the right to claw back any additional leave granted if the official arrangement differs from the submitted documentation.

27.3 Interns and Part-Time Employees

- **Part-Time Employees:** Part-time employees are entitled to maternity benefits, with salary payments prorated based on their contracted working schedule.
- **Interns:** Interns who have served for a continuous period of at least 3 months are entitled to 16 weeks of statutory maternity leave. Interns whose spouse donates SPL can extend their Maternity Leave by up to 26 weeks. Interns must take their 16 weeks of maternity leave consecutively.

27.4 Planning and Requesting Leave

- **Timelines:** The earliest you can start your leave is 28 days before your expected due date. You must take the first 8 weeks (56 days) consecutively. You can request to take the next 16 weeks (80 working days) flexibly over a 12-month period following your child's birth.
- **Notice:** You should give your manager at least 4 weeks of notice regarding your leave dates.
- **System Recording:** You must enter your maternity leave in WorkWeek using two separate codes: "Singapore Leaves > SG - Maternity Leave (First 8 weeks)" and "Singapore Leaves > SG - Maternity Leave (80 working days)".

27.5 Compensation and Benefits During Leave

- **Pay and Bonuses:** Your salary will continue as if you were working your normal hours, and you remain eligible to receive your company or sales bonus calculated using on-target multipliers.
- **Equity and Accruals:** Stock will continue to vest as normal, and you will continue to accrue vacation.
- **Holidays:** Your leave will *not* be extended by any public holidays that occur during your leave.
- **Benefits:** Health, life, disability, and travel insurance, as well as retirement contributions, gym reimbursement, and internet reimbursement, will continue as normal.

27.6 Return to Work and Conduct

- **Transitioning Back:** You can use up to 2 weeks of ramp back time to help transition back to work, and you can access onsite lactation rooms for nursing.
- **System Access:** The company encourages you to focus on your leave. Office visits and access to corporate systems should be kept to a minimum; if you access systems regularly or attempt to perform work, the company has the right to suspend your access.
- **Intellectual Property:** You remain subject to your employment contract and Confidential Information and Invention Assignment Agreement; any intellectual property you create during your leave belongs to the company.
- **Returning and Separations:** You must notify your manager of your return-to-work date. If you leave the company, your leave stops on your End Date, and you will not be paid out for any unused maternity leave.

Here is the drafted text for the new section based on the "Ramp-back time (Global)" document. You can insert this into your Altostrat Singapore handbook as the next section (e.g., Section 28) to maintain consistent formatting and tone.

SECTION 28: RAMP-BACK TIME (GLOBAL)

28.1 Purpose and Eligibility

- **Purpose:** Coming back from maternity, adoption, fostering, or baby bonding leave can be an adjustment. Ramp-back time allows you to take up to 2 weeks on a reduced schedule while receiving your full salary to help ease the transition back to work.
- **Eligible Personnel:** Full-time, part-time, and fixed-term employees are eligible for ramp-back time. To use this benefit, you must have taken at least 10 consecutive weeks of maternity, adoption, parental, and/or baby bonding time.
- **Ineligible Personnel:** Interns, temps, vendors, and contractors are not eligible for ramp-back time.

- **Usage Limits:** If you have, adopt, or foster multiple children at the same time, or if you use your leave intermittently, you are only eligible for one period of ramp-back time.

28.2 Schedule and Duration

- **Timing:** Ramp-back time can only be taken immediately upon the first 2 weeks of your return to work. If you take other leaves (like vacation, parental leave, or unpaid time off) to extend your maternity or baby bonding period, you can still take ramp-back time during the first 2 weeks of your eventual return.
- **Work Requirements:** During your two-week ramp-back period, you must work a minimum of 50% of your normal weekly hours each week.
- **Holidays:** If a single holiday falls during your ramp-back time, your usual work week hours are reduced (e.g., to 32 hours instead of 40), and you are expected to work half of those reduced hours for that week (e.g., 16 hours). The holiday counts as one of your ramp-back days.

28.3 Compensation and Benefits

- **Pay:** You will be paid 100% of your normal weekly salary while you are on ramp-back time.
- **Part-Time Transition:** If you and your manager agree for you to continue working part-time permanently after your leave, you will be paid 100% of your new part-time salary for your 2 weeks of ramp-back time.
- **Benefits:** You will continue to be eligible for your bonus, benefits, and vacation accrual during ramp-back time.

28.4 Requesting and System Entry

- **Manager Alignment:** Before you return, you must discuss your ramp-back schedule with your manager.
- **Salaried Employees:** In WorkWeek, you must enter ramp-back time for the hours you are *not* working. You must select the days you are not working for all or part of the day, choose "Ramp Back Time" under the type, and type "Baby Bonding Leave" under the reason.
- **Hourly Employees:** On your timecard in gTime, enter your ramp-back time and choose "Ramp Back Time".
- **Gradual Return to Work:** You can choose to use your two weeks of ramp-back time before moving on to a longer-term gradual return-to-work or part-time schedule, though the ongoing arrangement requires manager approval.

SECTION 29: EXIT POLICY & GUIDELINES

29.1 Notice of Termination

- **Providing Notice:** If you plan on leaving the company, you must give notice of termination as required by your employment contract.
- **Resigning While on Leave:** If you are currently on an approved leave of absence (such as sick leave, maternity leave, baby bonding, or carer's leave) and do not plan on returning to work, you must discuss it with your manager and contact support as soon as possible, and you are still required to give notice of termination per your contract.
- **End Date:** All active leave accruals and approved time-off periods immediately stop on your official End Date.

29.2 Payout of Leaves upon Separation

When you leave the company, the treatment of your accrued and unused leave balances is as follows:

- **Vacation Leave:** You will be paid out for the current year's unused vacation balance. This payout is prorated based on the amount of time worked in the year, in addition to any eligible carryover vacation balance.
- **Negative Vacation Balances:** If you took more vacation than you earned at the time you leave, the excess amount will be deducted from your final paycheck.
- **Floating Holidays:** Unused floating holidays are not cashed out upon termination.
- **Other Paid Leaves:** You will **not** be paid out for any unused balances of Sick Leave, Hospitalization Leave, Childcare Leave, Maternity Leave, Baby Bonding Leave, or Carer's Leave.

29.3 Post-Employment Obligations (Confidentiality & IP)

- **Continuing Agreements:** Even after your employment ends, you remain subject to the terms of your employment contract and the Confidential Information and Invention Assignment Agreement you signed when you joined the company.
- **Intellectual Property:** Any intellectual property you created during your employment (including during any leave periods prior to your separation) belongs to the company, unless it falls within the specific exceptions described in your agreement.
- **Confidential Information:** You must properly secure, label, and dispose of any confidential material before your departure, and you must not disclose proprietary company information after you leave.

29.4 Retention of Employee Data

- **Data Storage:** When you leave the company, your employment record will be kept as needed to protect the company from legal claims and to satisfy our legal and compliance obligations. The specific retention period may depend on the local law in the country in which you were employed.

SECTION 30: New Employee Onboarding Guidelines

Welcome to Altostrat! We are thrilled to have you join our team. To help you integrate smoothly into our culture and operations, we have designed this onboarding guide. It covers the essential processes, core policies, and cultural expectations you need to know during your first few weeks.

Phase 1: First Week Essentials (Setup & Security)

1. Equipment and Hardware

- **Ordering:** To ensure you have the tools you need, you must order your monitors, security keys, software, and other hardware exclusively through the internal **ITSM** case.
- **IT Support:** For technical support or help articles regarding your setup or remote work tools.

2. Physical and Network Security

- **Badging:** You must wear your company badge visibly at all times while on Altostrat premises. Do not tamper with or disable security and safety devices. If you see someone in a secure space without a badge, report it to Security immediately.
- **Data Protection:** You are bound by the Confidential Information and Invention Assignment Agreement signed upon hiring. Any intellectual property you create during your employment belongs to Altostrat.
- **Public Settings:** If you are working remotely or flexibly, do not work on confidential projects in public settings (like coffee shops). You are required to use privacy screens, wear headphones during virtual meetings, and keep sensitive documents secured.

Phase 2: Core Ethics & Mandatory Training

1. Mandatory Training You are required to complete all assigned compliance and role-specific training in a timely fashion. This ensures you understand our legal and ethical obligations.

2. The Code of Conduct & Anti-Bribery

- **Core Principle:** Our policy is simple: don't bribe. Never offer, give, or receive anything of value to/from a government official or commercial partner to obtain an improper advantage.

- **Government Approvals:** Any interaction involving gifts, meals, or items of value given to a government official requires written pre-approval from the Risk, Compliance & Integrity (RCI) team via [email](#).
- **Commercial Gifts:** Gifts and entertainment with non-government partners must be moderate. Anything over US\$100 requires manager pre-approval, and strict limits apply to frequency.

3. Conflicts of Interest

- You must avoid circumstances that create a conflict of interest or the appearance of one.
- If you have outside employment, significant investments in a competitor, or a personal relationship with a vendor you manage, you must disclose it to your manager and seek review from Ethics and Business Integrity (EBI) at [company intranet](#).

Phase 3: Navigating the Workplace & Culture

1. Community Guidelines

- **Focus on the Work:** Our primary responsibility is to do the work we were hired to do. Disrupting the workday to engage in raging debates over politics, the news, or non-work topics is prohibited.
- **Respect Each Other:** We maintain a zero-tolerance policy for harassment, discrimination, bullying, trolling, or doxxing.
- **Speaking Up:** If you observe inappropriate conduct or policy violations, you are encouraged to speak up. You can report concerns to your manager, HR, the Respect@ team, or anonymously via the Compliance Helpline at [email](#).

2. Personal Relationships at Work

- While we encourage a friendly community, romantic, physical, or familial relationships are strictly prohibited if one person is in a position to supervise or exercise authority over the other (including dotted lines and project leads).
- If you find yourself in a potentially conflicting relationship, you must report it immediately to HR. (Note: Employees at the VP level or above must disclose *all* such relationships regardless of reporting lines).

3. Alcohol, Smoking, and Drugs

- **Substances:** Illegal drugs (including marijuana, regardless of local laws) are strictly prohibited at work or work events.
- **Alcohol:** While alcohol is not banned at company events, you are held to the same Code of Conduct at all times. Excessive consumption is not permitted.
- **Smoking:** Smoking and vaping are strictly prohibited inside company buildings and on company shuttles.

Phase 4: Time Off & Leaves

1. Vacation Leave

- **First Year Proration:** In your first year, you will earn a prorated number of vacation days based on your start date.
- **Booking:** You must discuss and obtain approval from your manager at least 15 days in advance, and log all approved time off in Workday.
- **Floating Holidays:** If a public holiday falls on a weekend, you receive a floating holiday to be used before the end of the calendar year.

2. Sick Time

- If you are unfit for work, you must notify your manager at least one hour before your normal start time.
- If you are sick for more than two consecutive work days, you must submit a Medical Certificate (MC) from a registered practitioner in Workday within 48 hours.

3. Other Leaves Altostrat offers comprehensive leave policies to support your life events, including Maternity Leave, Baby Bonding Leave, Childcare Leave, Carer's Leave, and Bereavement Leave. Review the specific policies in the handbook or at [company intranet](#) for eligibility and allowances.

Phase 5: Travel & Expenses

1. Booking Travel

- All flights and hotels must be booked at least 3 weeks in advance through the TRIPS portal to secure reasonable rates and ensure compliance with regional caps.

2. Expense Submission

- **Corporate Card:** If you incur significant business expenses (>\$10,000 per quarter) or single transactions over \$5,000, you must use your corporate credit card.
- **Reimbursement:** All expenses must be submitted through Concur within 30 days of travel. Individual and group meals are capped at US\$120 per employee per day.

Next Steps for Your First Week:

1. Log into [ITSM](#) and [open a case](#) to order your necessary equipment.
2. Complete your mandatory compliance and security training modules.
3. Review your specific benefits and leave entitlements at [company intranet](#).
4. Set up a brief sync with your manager to discuss your working schedule, remote work arrangements, and initial project goals.

SECTION 30: PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT & DISCIPLINARY PROCESS

30.1 Performance Management

- **Annual Reviews:** Altostrat is committed to the continuous development of its employees. Employees will participate in annual Performance Management cycles to evaluate goals, assess core competencies, and discuss career growth.
- **Ongoing Feedback:** Managers and employees are expected to hold regular 1:1 check-ins to ensure alignment on business priorities and performance expectations throughout the year.

30.2 Performance Improvement

- **Performance Improvement Plan (PIP):** If an employee's performance falls below expectations, the manager and HR may place the employee on a formal Performance Improvement Plan. The PIP will outline specific, measurable goals and a timeline for expected improvement. Failure to meet the objectives of a PIP may result in reassignment or termination of employment.

30.3 Progressive Disciplinary Process For violations of company policies or codes of conduct, Altostrat generally follows a progressive disciplinary process, though the company reserves the right to accelerate this process based on the severity of the offense.

1. **Verbal Warning:** A documented conversation outlining the issue and expected correction.
2. **Written Warning:** A formal notice placed in the employee's personnel file.
3. **Final Written Warning / Suspension:** A final notice indicating that immediate termination will result if the behavior continues, potentially accompanied by unpaid suspension.
4. **Termination:** Separation of employment for repeated or severe violations (e.g., gross misconduct, fraud, violence, or severe harassment).

SECTION 31: COMPENSATION, PAYROLL & NON-LEAVE BENEFITS

31.1 Payroll and Salary

- **Pay Periods:** Salaries are paid on a monthly basis. Payments are made via direct deposit to the employee's designated bank account by the last working day of the month.
- **Deductions:** The company will make all necessary statutory deductions, including applicable income tax withholdings for foreign workers and statutory provident fund contributions.

31.2 Central Provident Fund (CPF)

- **Contributions:** For Singapore Citizens and Permanent Residents, Altostrat contributes to the Central Provident Fund (CPF) in strict accordance with the prevailing rates set by the CPF Board. Both the employer's and the employee's share of contributions will be processed automatically through payroll.

31.3 Non-Leave Perks & Benefits

- **Allowances:** Employees may be eligible for monthly internet reimbursements, wellness/gym subsidies, and mobile phone allowances. Details and eligibility requirements for these perks can be found on the Company Website.

SECTION 32: HEALTH INSURANCE & CLAIMS PROCESS

32.1 Coverage Overview

- Altostrat provides comprehensive health insurance for all eligible full-time and part-time employees. Coverage includes inpatient hospitalization, outpatient general practitioner (GP) and specialist care, dental, and vision benefits.

32.2 Health Insurance Claims Process To request a reimbursement for out-of-pocket medical, dental, or vision expenses covered by the company insurance plan, employees must follow this procedure:

1. **Obtain Documentation:** Ensure you receive an itemized final receipt and a medical certificate or diagnosis note from the attending physician or clinic.
2. **Submit via Portal:** Log into the benefits claims portal located on the Company Website.
3. **Upload Details:** Select the appropriate claim category (e.g., Outpatient GP, Dental), enter the treatment date, diagnosis, and total amount paid. Upload clear, legible copies of your receipts and medical documents.
4. **Timelines:** All medical claims must be submitted within 30 days of the treatment date. Late submissions may be rejected by the insurance provider.
5. **Reimbursement:** Once approved by the insurance provider, reimbursements will be credited directly to your bank account alongside your standard monthly payroll processing.

SECTION 33: ACCEPTABLE USE OF IT RESOURCES & SOCIAL MEDIA

33.1 Acceptable Use of IT Systems

- **Company Property:** All electronic facilities—including laptops, mobile devices, corporate networks, and software—are company property provided to help you perform your job effectively.
- **Unauthorized Software:** Employees must not download or install unapproved software, illegal content, or pirated media on company devices. All hardware and software requests must be routed through the Company Website.

- **Corporate Monitoring:** Altostrat reserves the right to monitor, access, and disclose employee communications and file usage on corporate electronic facilities where there is a business need to do so (e.g., protecting security, investigating misconduct, or ensuring compliance).

33.2 Social Media Guidelines

- **Protecting Information:** Employees must never disclose confidential, proprietary, or unreleased product information on personal social media accounts or external platforms.
- **Speaking on Behalf of Altostrat:** Do not represent or give the impression that you are speaking on behalf of the company unless you have explicit authorization from Corporate Communications.

SECTION 34: WORKPLACE HEALTH & SAFETY (WSH)

34.1 Safety Commitment

- Altostrat is committed to maintaining a safe, healthy, and violence-free work environment in compliance with the Singapore Workplace Safety and Health Act (WSHA).

34.2 Emergency Procedures

- Employees must familiarize themselves with the evacuation routes, emergency exits, and assembly points for their specific office location. Do not tamper with safety equipment or fire doors.

34.3 Reporting Accidents & WICA Compliance

- **Incident Reporting:** Any workplace accident, injury, or potential safety hazard must be reported immediately to your manager and the Workplace Facilities team via the Company Website.
- **Work Injury Compensation:** Altostrat fully complies with the Work Injury Compensation Act (WICA). If you sustain an injury during the course of your employment, the company will facilitate medical coverage and compensation as mandated by the Ministry of Manpower (MOM).

34.4 Ergonomics

- Employees working in the office or teleworking are encouraged to utilize ergonomic assessments available through the Company Website to ensure their workstations promote healthy posture and prevent repetitive strain injuries.

SECTION 35: GRIEVANCE & DISPUTE RESOLUTION

35.1 Open Door Policy

- Altostrat encourages open and honest communication. If you experience a workplace conflict, misunderstanding, or operational dispute, we encourage resolving it as close to the source as possible.

35.2 Formal Grievance Process If a concern cannot be resolved informally, employees should follow these steps:

1. **Step 1 (Direct Manager):** Raise the grievance in writing to your direct manager, detailing the issue and the desired resolution. The manager will review and respond within 5 working days.
2. **Step 2 (HR Escalation):** If the manager is involved in the grievance, or if the resolution is unsatisfactory, the employee may escalate the matter to their designated HR Business Partner via the Company Website.
3. **Step 3 (Formal Review):** HR will conduct an impartial review, which may involve gathering statements and holding meetings with relevant parties. HR will issue a final, binding resolution.

35.3 Non-Retaliation

- No employee will face adverse action, demotion, or retaliation for raising a grievance in good faith or participating in a dispute resolution process.